

An independent maritime OSINT case study assessing a possible ship-to-ship rendezvous involving two laden tankers south-east of Malta. The analysis combined AIS vessel particulars, reported draught, destination fields, last port calls and movement patterns. The report separates observed facts from analytical judgement, assigns confidence levels, evaluates competing explanations and documents key collection gaps. The assessment was deliberately kept at moderate confidence because hull proximity and physical transfer were not independently confirmed.

Sources: Public AIS aggregators and open-source maritime data.

Methods: Track review, loitering filter, vessel pairing, origin comparison and confidence assessment.

Key judgement: Possible STS rendezvous was the most plausible explanation, but not proven.

Limitations: No direct imagery, no measured hull separation and AIS data may be stale or inaccurate.

Skills demonstrated: OSINT research, maritime analysis, geospatial reasoning, source evaluation and structured reporting.